



Small Businesses Together Through Community Events

A6: Med-Fi Prototype ReadMe

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Overview

Stitch is a mobile platform that stitches small businesses together through community events. We create smarter, warmer connections between local businesses and communities by turning collaborations into repeatable, real-world experiences.

Target Audience

Stitch is designed to "**stitch small businesses together through community events**". As a collaboration platform, Stitch is built for time-constrained small business owners who want to partner with values-aligned businesses for joint events and co-marketing, but currently lack efficient tools to discover partners and coordinate collaborations beyond manual outreach.

Context: When & Why Use Stitch?

When Is Stitch Used?

- When a small business owner wants to find collaboration partners for upcoming community events.

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- When a small business owner seeks to expand customer reach through value-aligned partnerships.
 - When a small business owner plans a co-hosted event with complementary businesses.

What Should Users Accomplish?

- Discover potential business partners through AI-powered recommendations.
- Send collaboration requests and coordinate event details via in-app messaging.
- Create and manage "stitches" (collaborative events) with partner businesses.
- View and track ongoing collaborations in a centralized community hub.

Design Tools

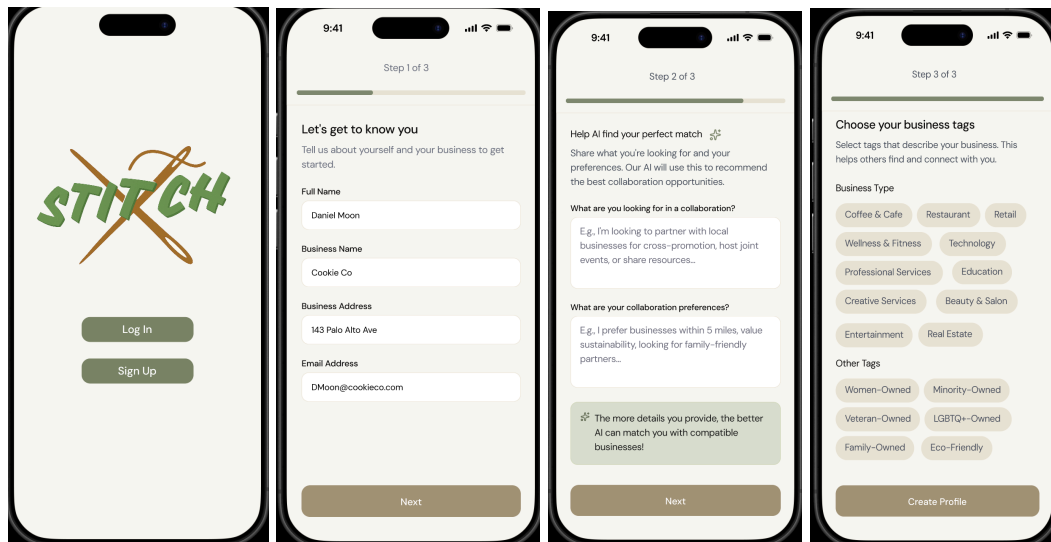
We chose Figma for its speed and collaborative features, which was critical when we needed to quickly test and refine flows based on user feedback from our low-fi tests. Our prototype is sized for the **iPhone 16 Pro**, although Stitch is intended as a cross-platform mobile app for any smartphone, whether IOS or Android.

Operating Instructions

Onboarding

The objective of the onboarding process is to allow a business to create a business profile to enable AI-powered partner matching and collaboration discovery.

The user starts at the **Stitch** screen showing the app logo with two options: "**Log In**" and "**Sign Up**." For this prototype, only the "**Sign Up**" button is clickable; the "Log In" button is non-functional. The user clicks "**Sign Up**" to begin the three-step onboarding process, indicated by a progress bar at the top of each screen.



There are three steps in the onboarding process:

Step 1: Let's Get to Know You.

The user is prompted to enter basic business information. Four text fields appear: Full Name, Business Name, Business Address, and Email Address. For this prototype, all fields are pre-populated when tapped and cannot be manually typed. The user needs to tap each field in order, and the information auto-fills. Once all fields are populated, the user taps the "**Next**" button at the bottom of the screen to proceed.

Step 2: Help AI Find Your Perfect Match.

The user is asked to share what they're looking for in a collaboration and their preferences to help the AI recommend suitable partners. Two large text input boxes appear with

placeholder examples. The first asks "What are you looking for in a collaboration?" with example text: "E.g., I'm looking to partner with local businesses for cross-promotion, host joint events, or share resources..." The second asks "What are your collaboration preferences?" with example text: "E.g., I prefer businesses within 5 miles, value sustainability, looking for family-friendly partners..."

For this prototype, when the user taps each text box, pre-written content auto-populates. A green informational banner appears at the bottom stating, "The more details you provide, the better AI can match you with compatible businesses!" The user then taps "Next" to continue.

Step 3: Choose Your Business Tags.

The user selects tags that describe their business to help others find and connect with them. Two categories appear: "Business Type" and "Other Tags." Under Business Type, options include: Coffee & Cafe, Restaurant, Retail, Wellness & Fitness, Technology, Professional Services, Education, Creative Services, Beauty & Salon, Entertainment, and Real Estate.

Under Other Tags, options include: Women-Owned, Minority-Owned, Veteran-Owned, LGBTQ+-Owned, Family-Owned, and Eco-Friendly. The user taps to select tags (e.g., Coffee & Cafe, Minority-Owned, Family-Owned), which change to a darker green color when selected. Once satisfied with their selections, the user taps the large "Create Profile" button at the bottom. The app automatically navigates to the **Home Page**, and the onboarding process is complete.

After onboarding, the user's information is saved and visible in the **Profile tab**, which is at the bottom navigation bar.

General Navigation

● Bottom Navigation Bar

- Home: Clicking on the Home button returns you to the main feed. This button works.
- Inbox: Clicking on the Inbox button allows you to access your messages' conversation history.
- Profile: This is clickable, and it contains the business profile information.

- Communities: Clicking on the Communities button takes you to the Communities page that has all your past and upcoming events, plus all the other events.

- **Back Buttons & 'Cancel' Buttons**

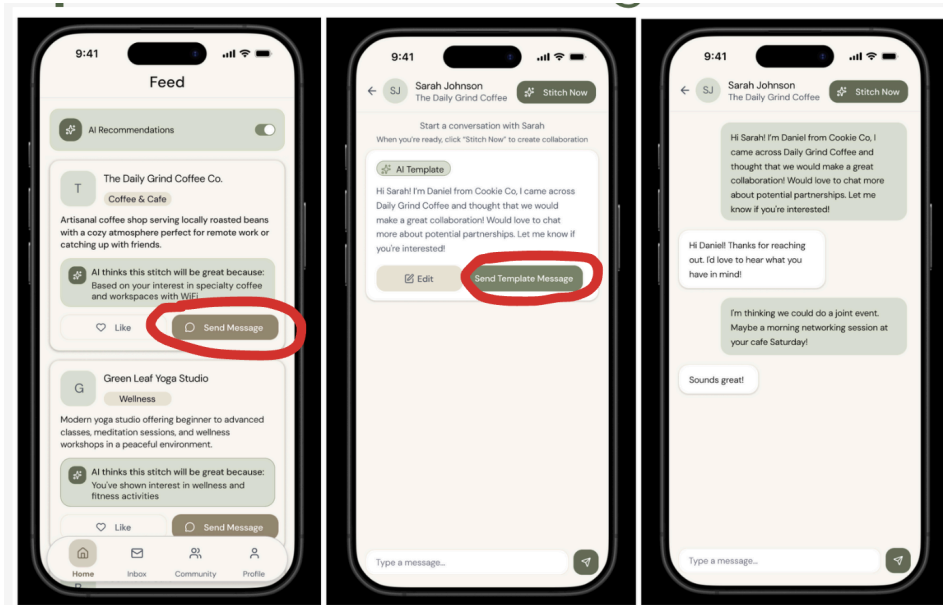
- The Back Arrow in the Inbox messaging page returns you to the previous page.
- The "Cancel" Button in the Stitch creation flow cancels the Stitch request and returns the user to the previous page.

- **AI Recommendations Toggle**

- Located at the top of the home page.
- Users can click "**ON**" and the feed will show AI-matched business recommendations.
- Users can click "**OFF**", and the feed will show a community feed with posts from other businesses, and a "+" button will also appear at the bottom of the feed that allows users to create a post.

Task Flows

- **Simple Task: Send a collaboration message.**



The objective of this task is to send an AI-templated message to another small business on the map so that you can collaborate together on an event.

The user starts at the home page, which has the feed. The default state for the feed is that it has the AI recommendations since the toggle button is **ON**.

The User will see the first AI-recommended business as “Daily Grind Coffee”. The user can click on the ‘**send message**’ button on the recommendation card of Daily Grind Coffee. The user will be navigated to a page with an auto-populated AI template message and will have two options: “**Edit**” and “**Send Template Message**”. For this prototype, the user cannot edit the templated message before sending. The User will then click “**Send Template Message**”, and the conversation thread will auto-populate showing the message exchange.

The task is then complete.

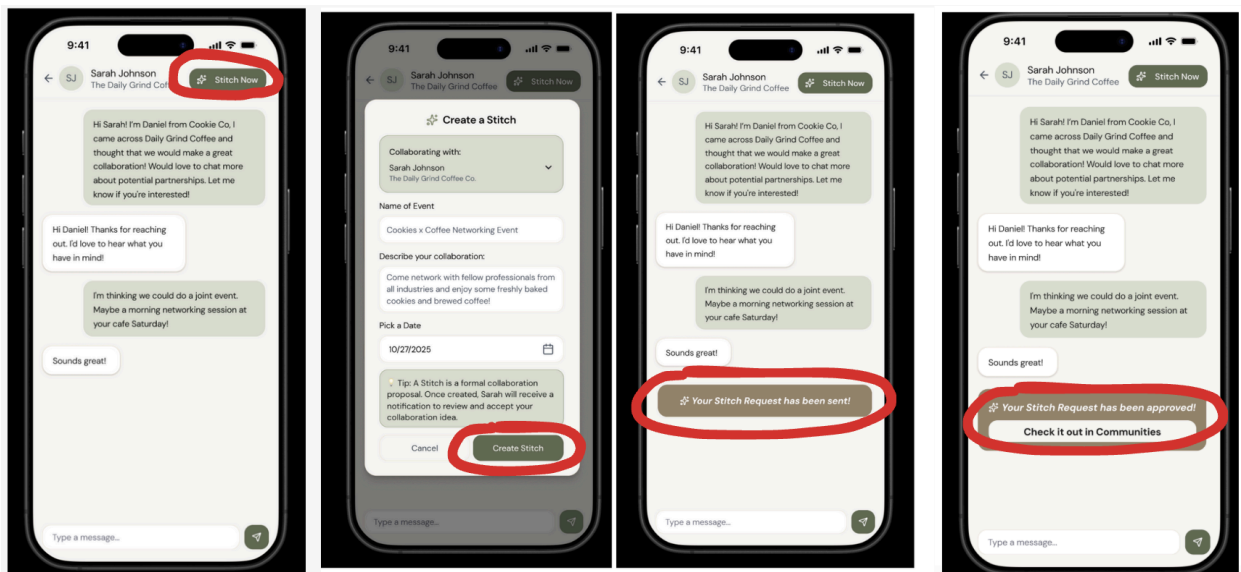
Available Options After Sending:

- The User can click “**Stitch Now**” to proceed to Task 2 (creating a collaboration event)
- The user can click the “**Back arrow**” to return to the message preview screen.

Limitations:

- The AI template message is not editable in this prototype.
- Only "Daily Grind Coffee" is messageable.
- "Type a message" text input is non-functional (demonstration purposes only).

• Medium Task: Post an event to find a collaboration.



The objective of this task is to create a collaboration request by posting an event or responding to a message.

The user starts by creating a **Stitch** from existing conversation.

The user navigates to the "**Inbox**" tab using the bottom navigation bar and sees a scrollable list of past conversations. For this prototype, only the first message in the list (with Sarah Johnson) is clickable. Upon clicking the first message to open the conversation with Sarah, the user reviews the conversation history and clicks the "**Stitch Now**" button to initiate a formal collaboration event. The user is then taken to the Stitch creation form, which in this prototype must be filled out in order from top to bottom. The user clicks the "**Name of Event**" text field and it auto-populates, then clicks "**Describe your collaboration**" which also auto-populates, and finally clicks "**Pick a Date**" to select a date from the October 2025 calendar. After filling all

fields, the user clicks "**Create Stitch**" to send the collaboration request. After approximately 800ms (simulating real-world processing time), the request is automatically approved using a Wizard of Oz technique. A confirmation message appears with a "**Check it out on Communities**" button, which navigates the user to the Communities page where they can view their new collaboration under "My Events."

The task is then complete.

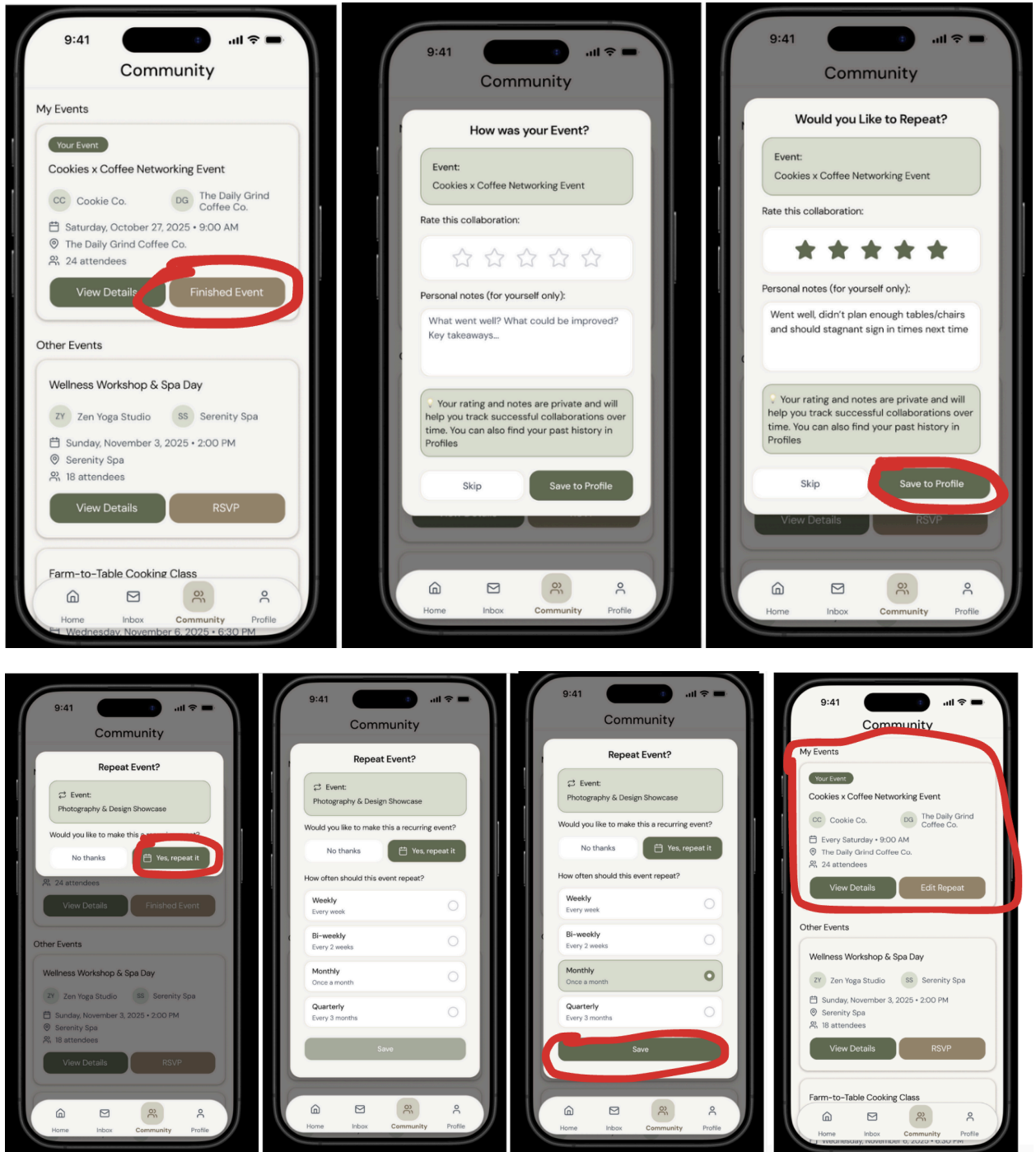
Additional Actions:

- From the Communities page, the user can click "**View Details**" on their event to see the guest list, event date and description, and collaborating business information. The user can also click "**Message**" to return to the conversation with their partner business. The "**Edit**" button that is visible on event details is also functional in this prototype and you can edit the details of the event.

Limitations:

- Only the first message that is with Sarah Johnson in the inbox is clickable.
- All text fields auto-populate and cannot be manually typed.
- Only October 2025 dates are available in the calendar picker.

- **Complex Task: Collaborate on multiple events.**



The objective of this task is to demonstrate how users manage recurring collaborations, provide post-event feedback, and set up repeating events through the Communities hub. This task shows the sustained value of Stitch beyond one-off

event creation, emphasizing how businesses can turn successful collaborations into ongoing partnerships.

This task is a continuation of the Medium Task. After the user has sent a collaboration request via **"Stitch Now"** and the request is automatically approved, the user receives a notification that their stitch has been approved. The user taps this notification, which navigates them directly to the **"Communities"** tab. The Communities screen displays two sections: **"My Events"** (active and past collaborations the user is part of) and **"Other Events"** (community events the user might join). For this prototype, only events under "My Events" are clickable.

The user sees their newly created collaboration event displayed as a card under "My Events," showing the event name ("Cookies x Coffee Networking Event"), collaborating businesses (Cookie Co. and The Daily Grind Coffee Co.), date/time, location, and attendee count. The user has two primary action options for this event: **"View Details"** or **"Finished Event."** If the user clicks **"View Details,"** they are taken to a detailed event screen showing the full event information including time, place, description, guest list, and partner business details. This screen allows users to review event logistics but does not offer editing functionality in this prototype.

If the user clicks **"Finished Event"** instead, an overlay appears asking "How was your event?" with options to provide a star rating (1-5 stars) and write personal notes about how the event went. These notes are private reminders for the business owner to track what worked well or what could be improved for future events. The user can then either **"Save"** their feedback or **"Skip"** to dismiss the overlay. If the user clicks **"Save,"** another overlay immediately appears titled **"Repeat Event?"** showing the event name and asking, **"Would you like to make this a recurring event?"** The user has two options: **"No thanks"** or **"Yes, repeat it"** If they select **"Yes, repeat it,"** a list of frequency options appears: Weekly (Every week), Bi-weekly (Every 2 weeks), Monthly (Once a month), or Quarterly (Every 3 months). The user selects their preferred frequency by tapping the radio button, then clicks **"Save"** to confirm. The event card in **"My Events"** updates to show **"Repeat Event"** instead of **"Finished Event"**. The user returns to the Communities feed where they can now see this event marked as recurring.

By clicking the back arrow from any screen, the user returns to the Communities feed, where they can see all past, active, and recurring events in one centralized location. This allows business owners to track multiple partnerships simultaneously, maintain records of successful collaborations, and easily set up repeating events without starting from scratch each time.

The task is complete once the user has navigated through the event feedback flow, optionally set up a recurring event, and understands how to manage ongoing collaborations.

Key Values Demonstrated:

This task flow shows how Stitch helps small business owners move beyond isolated one-time collaborations to sustained, repeatable partnerships. The Communities hub provides visibility into all collaboration activity, making it easy to reference past events, plan future ones, and maintain ongoing relationships with partner businesses.

Limitations:

- Only events under "My Events" are clickable; the "Other Events" section is non-functional in this prototype.
- The "Edit" functionality for events is not available in this prototype.
- Star ratings and personal notes are saved locally but not shared with partner businesses in this prototype
- Event timeline and task management features are visible but not interactive.
- Users cannot manually create recurring events; they must finish an event first, then choose to repeat it
- Guest list and advanced event features are displayed but limited in functionality.

Limitations

This medium-fidelity prototype focuses on demonstrating the core task flows and interactions rather than full feature completeness. We have intentional limitations that allow us to test critical user flows without building the entire app infrastructure, which will allow us to iterate quickly based on user feedback and focus our testing on the highest-priority features, such as partner discovery, messaging, and event creation.

Several elements are non-functional in this prototype, as mentioned under the limitations part in each task flow. For example, the like button on feed posts is non-clickable, as social engagement features are secondary to our primary focus on partnership formation. Edit event functionality is non-functional in the Communities view, and all text input requires keyboard functionality, which auto-populates when fields are selected rather than allowing manual typing. Only the "Daily Grind Coffee" message thread is functional, as we prioritized demonstrating one complete messaging flow over building multiple conversation threads. Similarly, only "My Events" are clickable in the Communities section, while "Other Events" remains non-functional. External media capabilities, such as photo or video uploads for events, are not included, and there are no screen transitions.

Interactivity is intentionally limited to specific task flows that demonstrate our three core tasks. Only the first message in the inbox is clickable, and only the AI recommendation for "Daily Grind Coffee" is actionable, ensuring test users follow the intended task flows without getting lost in non-functional areas. AI template messages cannot be edited in this version, allowing us to test whether business owners find value in automated messaging before investing in customization features. Finally, dates must be selected from a pre-defined October 2025 calendar rather than an open date picker, which simplifies testing logistics and ensures consistent data across test sessions. These limitations are strategic choices that enable us to gather meaningful feedback on core functionality while maintaining a manageable prototype scope.

Wizard-Of-Oz features

We employed several Wizard of Oz techniques to simulate real app functionality and create a realistic user experience:

1. Auto-Populated Conversations

When the user clicks "**Send Template Message**," the entire conversation thread instantly populates, showing both sent and received messages. This simulates real-time messaging without backend infrastructure.

2. Automatic Stitch Approval

After clicking "**Create Stitch**," the collaboration request is automatically approved after an 800ms delay. This mimics realistic approval time from another business owner without requiring actual user participation, and it demonstrates successful collaboration flow.

3. Pre-Selected Dates

The Date picker only shows October 2025 as the specific dates available. This simplifies the testing flow and ensures consistency across test sessions.

4. Auto-Populated Form Fields

When a user clicks on text input fields in the Stitch creation form, content automatically fills in. This eliminates the need for keyboard input, which is not supported in Figma prototypes, while demonstrating form completion flow.

5. Instant Event Updates

Stitched events immediately appear in the Communities Events tab. This simulates real-time event updates that would normally require backend sync.

Hard-Coded Items

These are the elements that used pre-set content and that cannot be modified by users during testing because of the limitations of Figma:

1. AI Template Messages

- Pre-written collaboration pitch message ready to be sent.
- Cannot be edited or customized in this prototype.

2. Event Post Content

- Feed post text is pre-determined.
- Appears when the user clicks the "+" button.
- No custom text input available.

3. Stitch Form Details

- Event name: Auto-fills with pre-set text.
- Collaboration description: Auto-fills with pre-set text.
- Only date selection offers a limited choice (October 2025).

4. Conversation History

- All message threads with "Daily Grind Coffee" are pre-scripted.
- Users cannot type new messages beyond the initial template sent.

5. Business Data

- All business profiles (names, values, types) are pre-set.
- Cannot modify business information during prototype testing

6. Calendar Dates

- Only October 2025 dates are available for the user to select.